

IT fault handling improvement

Management briefing | Page 1 of 2 | Fictional portfolio scenario

To: Unit Manager | From: portfolio project author | Date: 9 October 2026

Decision sought

Approve a short discovery and pilot design to validate the service problem, platform fit and assurance requirements. This is a simulated decision request; no real budget or organisational authority is assumed.

Recommendation

Assess the existing approved service management platform first and configure it if fit for purpose. If it cannot meet the requirements, design a small Microsoft 365 pilot in an approved tenant, conditional on privacy, security and records gates. Use the web prototype to test workflow, not as a production solution.

Issue and evidence

The fictional unit tracks faults through emails and spreadsheets, creating duplicate handling, unclear ownership and unconfirmed closure. Six simulated findings and an invented sample of 50 faults support the exercise. Actual interviews, observations and service data must validate the problem and baseline before investment.

Options

Option	Benefits	Trade-offs	Assessment
A: improve spreadsheet	Low effort; clearer fields and owners	Fragmentation and weak control evidence persist	Interim fallback
B: approved service platform	Reuse identity, support and records capabilities	Availability, licences and fit need confirmation	Preferred
C: Microsoft 365 low-code	Flexible intake and workflow; familiar suite	Permissions, flows, records and licensing need assurance	Conditional pilot
D: custom production app	Maximum workflow flexibility	Highest build, assurance and support burden	Not recommended

Benefits risks and next steps

Management briefing | Page 2 of 2 | Fictional portfolio scenario

Indicative benefit and effort

Assuming 50 faults per month and active administration reduced from 12 to 6 minutes: $50 \times 6 / 60 = 5$ staff hours per month. At an assumed A\$65 loaded hourly rate, potential capacity value is A\$325 per month or A\$3,900 per year. This is not cash savings. At 25-100 faults per month, the same assumption releases 2.5-10 hours. Demand and improvement remain unverified.

Allow an indicative 8-12 person-days for discovery, configuration, assessment, testing and training, excluding licensing, integrations and remediation. At 7.6 hours per day and A\$65 per hour, effort is A\$3,952-A\$5,928. This estimate is for comparison, not a quote or an approved business case. These assumptions do not yet support custom development.

Primary risks and conditions

Inadequate access control and uncontrolled records are unacceptable for production in the current browser demo. A live pilot requires assessed classification, approved data handling, enforced SSO and ownership permissions, protected records, authorised retention and tested restore. Confirm platform location, licensing, supplier terms, support and incident channels.

Mitigate adoption and accessibility risks with shift-friendly training, champions, assisted reporting and representative task tests. Agree priority definitions and service targets with the coordinator and sponsor before live use.

Proposed sequence and decision gates

Weeks 1-2: validate the baseline, platform fit and requirements; agree assurance and measures. Week 3: execute target-platform UAT, access-denial and restore tests; train champions. Weeks 4-7: controlled pilot with daily queue review. Week 8: sponsor reviews performance, incidents, adoption and feedback and decides expand, revise or stop.

Measures and stop criteria

Track active handling time, submission completeness, status-chasing contacts, confirmed closure and service/accessibility guardrails. No open Severity 1 or 2 defects or unaccepted High risks at pilot entry. Pause if access failures block critical work, a serious privacy/security event occurs or records cannot be recovered; use the approved fallback and reconcile changes before restart.

Supporting evidence: G01-G07; R01-R12; K01-K09; executed T01-T16; proposed U01-U04. Organisational UAT, consultation, rollout and benefits realisation have not occurred.